

Writing About Your Craft: A Storytelling Workbook

Why Your Story Matters

People don't just buy products — they buy stories, values, and connections. A buyer choosing between two similar mugs will choose the one made by the potter whose story they connect with. Your words are part of what you sell.

Exercise 1 — Your Origin Story

Answer these questions in a few sentences each:

How did you start making [your craft]? _____

What drew you to it? Was it a person, a place, a moment? _____

What do you love most about the process? _____

What do you want the person who buys your work to feel? _____

Exercise 2 — Your About Page Draft

Write 3 sentences using this formula:

Sentence 1: What you make and where you make it.

Sentence 2: Why you make it — your values or your passion.

Sentence 3: What you want for your customers.

Example: "I make hand-thrown stoneware pottery in my studio in rural Devon. Every piece is made to be used — designed for real kitchens, not display cabinets. My work is for people who want a daily object that feels considered and honest."

Exercise 3 — Product Description Formula

Line 1: What is it? (Descriptive, concrete)

Line 2: What makes it special? (Materials, process, story)

Line 3: Who is it for / when would they use it?

Line 4: Practical details (size, care, lead time)

Exercise 4 — 5 Things About Your Craft

Write down 5 things that are true about how you work that most buyers wouldn't know. These become the foundation of your social media content.

3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Words to Use / Words to Avoid

Use: handmade, hand-thrown, hand-cut, small batch, made to order, studio, made in [place], considered, honest, everyday, heirloom

Avoid: unique (overused), amazing (vague), perfect (pressure), artisanal (tired), luxury (unless truly positioning there)